CHILD SUPERVISION

ISSUED 23/10/2025

PURPOSE: The Club has developed this policy to protect the safety and wellbeing of all junior players attending Club events including training sessions. It sets out clear supervision responsibilities for parents, guardians, and the Club, ensuring compliance with Victorian child safety laws and our Club's duty of care obligations and existing conditions set by the Bendigo Basketball Association (BBA).

REVISION: All Club policies, procedures guides and checklists are reviewed every January following the appointment of the new committee in November of each year. They may also be reviewed before each season or too meet compliance requirements.

POLICY STATEMENT: The Club is committed to providing a safe and supervised environment **only during official training sessions and scheduled games**.

- Coaches and volunteers are responsible for player safety and instruction **only during the designated session or game**.
- They are **not responsible for supervising children before or after** these times.
- Parents and guardians remain **fully responsible** for their child's supervision outside official activity times.

When activities are held under BBA jurisdiction and venues such as Red Energy Arena, all families must comply with the venue's entry and supervision requirements.

SCOPE: This policy applies to all junior players, parents/guardians, coaches, and team officials involved in Club training sessions, games, or activities held at any venue. It operates in conjunction with the BBA and venue-specific conditions, including those set by Red Energy Arena.

SUPERVISION RESPONSIBILITIES:

- The Club provides active supervision **only during official sessions or games** listed in the Club's schedule.
- Unsupervised children must **not arrive before scheduled start times** and must be **collected at scheduled end times.**
- The Club **cannot and will not accept responsibility** for children left unattended outside these times.
- Coaches and volunteers are **not expected or permitted** to supervise early arrivals, late pick-ups, or siblings.
- **Siblings and non-participating children** must remain under direct parent/guardian supervision at all times.

RISK AND INSURANCE:

- The Club's insurance and Basketball Victoria coverage apply **only during official, supervised or endorsed Club activities**.
- Any incident or injury occurring outside these times **may not be covered** by insurance.
- Volunteers and coaches are protected **only while acting within the scope of their official duties**.

PHOENIX UNITED BASKETBALL DEVELOPMENT CLUB INC
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LEGAL OBLIGATIONS AND CHILD SAFETY RISKS: Under *Section 494 of the Children, Youth and Families Act 2005 (Vic)*:

"A parent or guardian must not leave a child unattended for a period that places the child at risk of harm. The maximum penalty is 3 penalty units or up to 6 months' imprisonment."

Leaving a child unsupervised at a venue, such as dropping them off well before training or collecting them long after **may breach this law**.

The Club has **zero tolerance for unsupervised children** outside training or game times. Given venue-specific risks (such as open public access, vehicle traffic, and large crowds), any instance of a child being left unsupervised will be treated as a **serious child safety breach**.

If this occurs, the Club will:

1. Ensure the immediate safety of the child.
2. Contact the parent or guardian for collection.
3. Record the incident in the Club's Child Safety Register.
4. Require a meeting with the parent/guardian before the child returns to training or games.

Repeated or serious breaches may result in **suspension or removal** from Club activities and, where appropriate, **referral to relevant authorities**.

EXPECTATIONS OF PARENTS AND GUARDIANS: Parents and guardians must:

- Accompany their child to and from training and games.
- Ensure **timely drop-off and collection** aligned with schedules.
- Notify the coach or team manager if another authorised adult will collect their child.
- Avoid relying on other families, coaches, or volunteers for informal supervision.
- Remain with siblings or non-training children at all times.
- Comply with all **Bendigo Basketball League and venue conditions**.

RELATED POLICIES:

- Child safety Policy
- All Code of Conduct Policies
- Volunteer Policy

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